

1.1 Unit description

This unit introduces students to the content of plays written for the theatre. They will learn how to analyse plays in a variety of ways so that they become familiar with the way written plays can be interpreted for realisation in performance.

The focus of this unit is to use practical drama to explore two contrasting plays. Students will:

- be given opportunities to explore the use of language, structure and characterisation
- explore the potential for staging plays
- explore the social, cultural, historical and political elements of the plays
- show how the meaning of a play might be interpreted and communicated to an audience
- consider how the application of dramatic elements (ie movement, vocal expression, sound, light, costume, masks, props and setting) contribute to the development and shaping of ideas for the performance of the selected plays
- evaluate the merits of both the plays they have explored and consider their worth in society today
- record their practical findings in a set of *Exploration Notes* using appropriate drama and theatre terms and concepts
- explore at least one of the plays in terms of at least one recognised practitioner.

Students must see at least one live theatre performance and:

- write an evaluation of the performance seen
- have a working knowledge of production values and be able to make critical and evaluative judgements.